

The Doctor Visit Prep Kit

Low-Carb Edition

Walk in organized. Walk out with answers.

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How to use this kit

You changed how you eat, and you have a doctor's appointment coming up. Maybe you're a little nervous about that conversation. That's normal, and it's exactly why this kit exists.

Here's the truth I've seen over and over: doctors respond well to organized patients. When you walk in with your medications listed, your changes summarized on one page, and your questions written down, the whole visit changes. You're not defending a diet. You're two people looking at the same information together.

This kit isn't a tracker and there's nothing to fill in daily. You'll use it once per appointment, in three stages:

Before your visit: Work through pages 2 to 8. Give yourself 20 to 30 minutes a few days ahead, not the night before. Fill in your medication list straight from your pill bottles, complete your one-page diet summary, and pick the questions you actually want answered.

During your visit: Hand your doctor page 5 (your one-page summary) at the start. It takes them 30 seconds to read and it sets the tone. Use page 7 for your questions and page 9 to write down what they say. You won't remember it all later. Nobody does.

After your visit: Keep page 10 somewhere handy. Questions always come up two days after the appointment. Write them down there so they're ready for next time.

One important thing before you start. This kit helps you organize information and ask better questions. It never replaces your doctor's judgment, and nothing in it is medical advice. You'll see that reminder again at the end, because it matters.

Let's get you ready.

Sarah, Health Coach, Carnivore Weekly

Before Your Visit Checklist

Get everything together before you go

A good appointment starts a few days early. Here's what to gather and what to do. Check things off as you finish them, and don't worry if a few don't apply to you. Skip what doesn't fit.

What to gather

- ☐ My completed medication and supplement list (pages 3 and 4 of this kit)
- ☐ My one-page diet change summary (page 5, filled in)
- ☐ My questions list (page 7, with my top 3 marked)
- ☐ Any home readings I've been keeping (blood pressure, glucose, weight), printed or in a log
- ☐ Copies of recent lab results, if I have them from another provider or an old portal
- ☐ My insurance or health card
- ☐ Photo ID
- ☐ Reading glasses, if I need them
- ☐ A pen (the office pen is never where you need it)
- ☐ List of every pharmacy I use, including mail order

What to do before the day

- ☐ Confirm the appointment date and time
- ☐ Ask the office if this visit includes lab work, and if so, whether I need to fast beforehand
- ☐ Ask how early to arrive for paperwork
- ☐ Arrange a ride or parking plan if I need one
- ☐ Fill in pages 3 through 8 of this kit
- ☐ Mark my top 3 questions on page 7, in case time runs short
- ☐ Note anything new since my last visit on page 8 (symptoms, changes, things I've noticed)

Day-of quick check

- ☐ This kit, filled in
- ☐ Medications question: do I need to bring the actual bottles? (Some offices prefer this. Call and ask.)
- ☐ Water and a snack for after, especially if the visit includes fasting lab work

My appointment date and time _____

Doctor or clinic name _____

Address and phone number _____

Current Medications Worksheet

Everything you take, in one place

Fill this in straight from your pill bottles and packages, not from memory. Copy the name and dose exactly as they appear on the label. If your doctor prescribed it, write their name in the last column. This page is for recording only. It doesn't tell you what to take or change, because that conversation belongs to you and your doctor.

Prescription medications

Medication Name (from the label)	Dose as Prescribed	How often I take it	Prescribed by

Over-the-counter medicines I take regularly

(Things like pain relievers, antacids, allergy pills, sleep aids)

Medicine Name	Amount I take	How often	Why I take it

Supplements, Allergies & Pharmacies

Supplements, vitamins, and minerals

(Include electrolytes, magnesium, fish oil, anything you take on purpose. Doctors need the full picture, and supplements count.)

SUPPLEMENT NAME	AMOUNT I TAKE	HOW OFTEN	WHY I TAKE IT

Allergies and reactions

Medications or substances I'm allergic to, and what happens

My pharmacies

Main pharmacy name and phone

Second pharmacy or mail-order service, if any

Date I completed this page

Tip: take a photo of this page once it's filled in. Then it's on your phone at every appointment, not just this one.

My Diet Change, In One Page

The 30-second summary your doctor can actually read

This is the most important page in the kit. Doctors are pressed for time, and a clear one-page summary beats ten minutes of explaining. Fill it in honestly, hand it over at the start of your visit, and let it do the talking. Plain facts, no defending, no convincing.

My name _____

Today's date _____

Date I started eating this way _____

What I eat now, in one or two sentences

(Example: "Mostly meat, eggs, and fish, with butter and some cheese. I drink water, coffee, and tea.")

What I eat now

What I stopped eating or cut way back on

Foods I stopped or reduced

What I eat most days

My typical day of eating

What I've noticed since starting

(Just what you've observed. Your doctor decides what it means.)

Energy _____ Sleep _____

Digestion _____ Weight change, if any _____

Anything else I've noticed

Why I'm doing this

(One honest sentence. "I want to lose weight and feel better" is a perfectly good answer.)

My reason

What I'd like from you today, doctor

(Example: "I'd like baseline labs, and I'd like to know what you want to monitor.")

What I'm asking for at this visit

Baseline Labs Request Sheet

Know what the common panels are before you ask about them

When you change how you eat, many doctors like to get a starting snapshot, then compare it against later results. That starting snapshot is what people mean by "baseline labs." Trends over time usually tell your doctor more than any single number can.

Here's what the commonly discussed panels actually are, in plain language. This is education about what the tests measure, not advice about what you need. Your doctor decides which tests make sense for you, and your doctor interprets the results. Reference ranges also vary from lab to lab, so the printout from one lab won't always match another. That's normal, and it's another reason interpretation belongs to your doctor.

CMP (Comprehensive Metabolic Panel). A standard blood panel that looks at things like blood sugar at the time of the draw, electrolytes such as sodium and potassium, kidney function markers, and liver function markers. It's a broad snapshot of how several body systems are running.

Lipid panel. Measures fats in your blood: total cholesterol, LDL, HDL, and triglycerides. If you've read about cholesterol and low-carb eating, this is the panel those conversations are about. What your results mean for you is a conversation for your doctor, because context matters a lot here.

A1c (hemoglobin A1c). An estimate of your average blood sugar over roughly the past three months. Unlike a single glucose reading, it reflects a longer stretch of time.

Thyroid panel. Usually starts with TSH, sometimes with added tests like T4 or T3. The thyroid helps regulate metabolism, and doctors sometimes like a baseline when eating habits change significantly.

Panels to ask my doctor about

(These checkboxes mean "I want to discuss whether this makes sense for me," nothing more.)

- ☐ CMP (Comprehensive Metabolic Panel)
- ☐ Lipid panel
- ☐ A1c
- ☐ Thyroid panel
- ☐ Anything else my doctor recommends

Other tests my doctor mentioned _____

Practical questions to ask at the same time

- ☐ Do I need to fast before the blood draw, and for how long?
- ☐ Will my insurance or provincial plan cover these, or is there a cost?
- ☐ When and how will I get the results?
- ☐ When would you want to recheck?

Date labs were requested _____

Date of blood draw _____

Recheck date my doctor suggested _____

12 Questions Worth Asking

Pick your top three first

Appointments go fast. If you only get time for three questions, you want them to be your three. Read through this list, check the ones that matter to you, then circle or star your top three. There's space at the bottom for your own.

These are the questions I've seen open up the best conversations between patients and doctors during a diet change.

- ☐ 1. Given my health history and my medications, is there anything you want to watch more closely while I change how I eat?
- ☐ 2. Would baseline labs make sense for me? Which ones would you order?
- ☐ 3. How soon would you want to recheck labs after I start?
- ☐ 4. I've read that some medications may need adjusting when eating habits change. Are any of mine in that category, and how will we handle that together?
- ☐ 5. Are there symptoms that should make me call your office right away?
- ☐ 6. Should I monitor anything at home, like blood pressure, glucose, or weight? How often?
- ☐ 7. How would you like me to share home readings with you: portal, printout, or phone call?
- ☐ 8. What results would tell you this way of eating is working for me? What would concern you?
- ☐ 9. If my labs change, how will we sort out what's from the diet versus something else?
- ☐ 10. Is there anything in my personal or family history that makes this way of eating riskier for me?
- ☐ 11. If I have a question between visits, who do I contact and what's the best way to reach them?
- ☐ 12. When should I book my next appointment, and what should we plan to review then?

My own questions

Question 13

Question 14

My top three question numbers _____

Symptoms & Changes to Mention

Don't trust your memory in the exam room

Here's something funny about appointments: the moment the doctor asks "any changes since last time?", your mind goes blank. Everyone's does. So write it down now, while you remember.

List anything new or different since your last visit, good or bad. Better sleep counts. A weird headache counts. You're not deciding what's important here, you're just reporting. Let your doctor decide what matters, because sometimes the thing you almost didn't mention turns out to be the useful one.

SYMPTOM OR CHANGE	WHEN IT STARTED	HOW OFTEN IT HAPPENS	BETTER, WORSE, OR ABOUT THE SAME

More detail on the big ones

(Pick the one or two things from the table that concern you most, and give them a few sentences each. When did it start, what does it feel like, what makes it better or worse?)

The change I most want to discuss

Second thing I want to discuss

Positive changes I want on the record

(These belong in your chart too. If your energy is up or your joints ache less, say so. It's part of your medical picture.)

Improvements I've noticed

Life context my doctor should know

(Stress, sleep changes, a new job, a loss, travel. Doctors read numbers better when they know the story around them.)

What else is going on in my life right now

Visit Notes

Write it down while it's fresh

Studies on patient recall agree on one thing: we forget a lot of what's said in the exam room, and quickly. Use this page during the visit or in the parking lot right after. Write what your doctor actually said, in their words where you can. If anything about your medications or care plan changes, copy it down exactly as your doctor stated it, and ask them to repeat it if you're not sure. Never work from memory on that part.

Visit date _____

Doctor or provider I saw _____

Reason for this visit _____

What the doctor said

Main points from the conversation

Labs or tests ordered

Tests ordered, and any fasting or prep instructions

Changes to my care plan

(Copy exactly what the doctor said. If you're unsure, ask them to write it down or repeat it before you leave.)

Changes, in the doctor's words

Home monitoring my doctor asked for

What to measure, how often, and how to share it

Follow-up

Recheck or follow-up date _____

Next appointment booked for _____

Who to call with questions, and the number _____

Things I didn't get to ask

(Move these to page 10 so they're ready for next time.)

Unanswered questions

Between-Visits Parking Lot

For the questions that show up on Tuesday night

The best questions never arrive during the appointment. They show up in the shower, in the car, or at 9 pm three days later. That's what this page is for. When a question comes up, park it here instead of losing it. Then bring this page to your next visit, or call the office if it can't wait.

One rule of thumb from my hub guide: if a question feels urgent, don't save it for the parking lot. Call your doctor's office and ask. That's what they're there for, and no printable should ever talk you out of making that call.

DATE IT CAME UP	MY QUESTION	ASKED?	ANSWER OR FOLLOW-UP

Things I want to remember to report next visit

(Not questions, just updates: readings, changes, wins, worries.)

Updates for next time

My next appointment date _____

Office phone number, so it's always on this page _____

The Fine Print That Isn't Fine Print + Resources

Please read this part. I mean it.

I'm not a doctor. I've researched this deeply and worked with many people, but I'm not your doctor. If you have health conditions, take medications, or need specific guidance, talk to someone who knows your full medical picture. Everything in this kit is educational, built from research and what I've seen work. Your situation might be different.

And one thing I want to say as plainly as I can: if you're taking medications or have been diagnosed with any medical condition, you need individualized medical oversight. Don't make changes without consulting your doctor. This kit exists to make those conversations better, never to replace them.

Nothing in these pages tells you what to take, what to stop, or what your results mean. The worksheets hold your information. The education pages explain what things are. Every decision stays where it belongs: with you and your doctor, together.

If you'd like more support

This kit pairs with my free guide, *Carnivore With Health Conditions and Medications*, over at Carnivore Weekly. It walks through doctor coordination in much more depth, including the full question bank that page 7 came from. You'll find it at **carnivoreweekly.com**.

Some people also find our free calculator helpful for estimating protein and energy needs as a starting point for the food conversation. It's at **carnivoreweekly.com** too. No account needed for either.

Thanks for taking your health, and your doctor's role in it, seriously. That combination is exactly what works.

Sarah

Health Coach, Carnivore Weekly

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